INCH-POUND

A-A-54976
9 September 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers nine surgical gut sutures suitable for use in surgery.

Salient characteristics:

General. Shall be surgical gut sutures. The size, length, and arming of every suture covered by this document shall be as specified below. If a suture is armed, the type of needle(s) specified below shall be attached to the suture. The shape and length of the needle(s) shall be as specified below. Needles shall not be attached to an unarmed suture. Sutures shall comply with the latest United States Pharmacopeia (USP) requirements for absorbable surgical sutures. (See Note 1)

General Requirements*

Suture No.	Suture Size	Suture Length	Suture Arming	Needle Type	Needle Shape	Needle Length
1	2-0	27 in	S-A	TPN	5/8 Circle	27 mm
2	2-0	36 in	S-A	TPN	1/2 Circle	37 mm
3	5-0	27 in	S-A	TPN	1/2 Circle	17 mm
4	0	36 in	S-A	TPN	1/2 Circle	40 mm
5	3-0	54 in	U-A	n/a	n/a	n/a
6	3-0	54 in	U-A	n/a	n/a	n/a
7	2-0	54 in	U-A	n/a	n/a	n/a
8	3-0	36 in	S-A	TPN	1/2 Circle	37 mm
9	0	18 in	U-A	n/a	n/a	n/a

* a) TPN - Taper Point Needle
b) S-A - Single Armed
c) U-A - Unarmed
d) n/a - Not Applicable

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Material.

Surgical gut shall be available in three varieties: gut tanned in chromic acid, gut lightly tanned in chromic acid, and untanned gut. Surgical gut tanned in chromic acid shall be designated as "treated gut". Surgical gut lightly tanned in chromic acid shall be designated as "medium treated gut". Untanned surgical gut shall be designated as "plain gut". Treated gut and medium treated gut shall comply with all USP requirements for "Type C" suture. Plain gut shall comply with all USP requirements for "Type A" suture. Every suture covered by this document shall be made of the surgical gut indicated below. (See Note 1)

Material Requirements

Suture No.	Suture Material
1	Treated Gut
2	Treated Gut
3	Treated Gut
4	Treated Gut
5	Plain Gut
6	Medium Treated Gut
7	Treated Gut
8	Treated Gut
9	Treated Gut

Suture needles shall be made of a corrosion resistant steel that complies with all requirements of American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) F899.

Style and design. Suture needles shall have a flattened needle body, a minimum of 4 longitudinal ribs on the inside and outside curvatures of the needle body, and a seamless swage. These requirements shall not apply to unarmed sutures.

Finish. Sutures shall have a smooth finish. Suture needles shall be stress-relieved and passivated. Suture needles shall have a bright and smooth finish.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

Workmanship.

Sutures shall be free from kinks, splinters, cuts, knots and any other defects that detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Suture needles shall be free from dull points, dulled edges, feathered edges, burrs, cracks, nicks, pits, corrosion, and any other defects that detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Sterility. Sutures shall be sterile. The sterility assurance level shall be 10^{-6}, minimum.

Sterile packaging. Sutures shall be sealed in peel-open, heat-sealed, leak-resistant double-packets. The packets shall maintain the sterility of their contents until they are opened or damaged. The packets shall comply with the requirements of American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) D3078. The packets shall be marked with the following: suture material, suture size, suture length, suture arming ("Unarmed", "Single Armed", or "Double Armed"), needle type, needle style, and the legend "Sterile". All packet markings shall be permanent and legible.

Instructions. Sutures shall be supplied with printed instructions concerning cautions, contraindications, and aseptic dispensing from sterile packaging.

Unit. Package (PG).

For suture 1, 2, 3, 4 and 8, each suture shall be individually packaged in a sealed-peel-open, leak-resistant double packet capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless packet is damaged or opened. One package containing 36 individually packaged sutures, as specified, constitutes one unit.

For suture 5, 6 and 7, each suture shall be wound on a dispensing reel and shall be individually packaged in a sealed-peel-open, leak-resistant double packet capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless packet is damaged or opened. One package containing 12 individually packaged sutures, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

For suture 9, three sutures shall be packaged in a sealed-peel-open, leak-resistant double packet capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless packet is damaged or opened. One package containing 36 sealed packets (3 sutures per packet), as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of inspections performed by or far the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, shall be defined as the examination and testing of an item. Examination shall be defined as unaided visual, auditory, tactile, or olfactory investigation. Testing shall be defined as the use of laboratory equipment and procedures to determine various properties of an item. Inspections shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample may be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. For inspection purposes, the unit of product shall be one suture, except when inspecting suture packets. When inspecting suture packets, the unit of product shall be one packet of sutures.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sampling shall be performed for each salient characteristic specified herein. For each sampling, inspection level S-2 shall be used; the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

Suture material shall be divided into samples in accordance with section 12.2 of American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) D1898. Needle material shall be divided into samples in accordance with section 13.4 of ASTM D1898. Ten-power magnification shall be used during the examination of sutures and suture needles.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE 1: To differentiate the sutures, each one is assigned a "Suture Number"; however, suture numbers shall be used only for this purpose. The National Stock Number (NSN) assigned to each suture shall be the primary reference number. NSNs and suture numbers are cross-referenced below.

NOTE 2: This document covers the following:

Suture #	NSN	Item Identification
1	6515-00-054-7446	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 2-0, Single-Armed, 36s
2	6515-00-060-6504	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 2-0, Single-Armed, 36s
3	6515-00-116-9103	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 5-0, Singled-Armed, 36s
4	6515-00-159-4891	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 0, Single-Armed, 36s
5	6515-00-727-4470	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Plain, Size 3-0, Unarmed, 12s

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

Suture #	NSN	Item Identification
6	6515-00-727-4471	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Medium Treated, Size 3-0, Unarmed, 12s
7	6515-00-727-4472	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 2-0, Unarmed, 12s
8	6515-00-836-7789	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 3-0, Single-Armed, 36s
9	6515-01-139-9117	SUTURE, ABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut, Treated, Size 0, Unarmed, 36s (3/packet)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-5712
Location: john/gut/dawne

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54976	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 94/09/09

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
SUTURE, NONABSORBABLE, SURGICAL, Gut

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: DPSC-MAP	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial: (215) 737-8431 (2) AUTOVON: 444-8431
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 South 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T09:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.